

ORACLE

DESIGN SYSTEM

VISUAL LANGUAGE · TWO REGISTERS · THE CONDITIONS OF FORM

Version 3.2 · April 2026

Interface Design and Interaction · Project II

IADE M-CCIA · Lisbon

REGISTER GUIDE

Which system do I use?

The Oracle Design System has two registers — not two separate systems. One visual language, two environments. Read this section first before building anything.

DOCUMENT REGISTER

Cream — the default

All outputs that exist outside the installation: reports, receipts, the website, academic documents, presentations. Light, legible, unhurried.

WEBSITE

REPORTS

THERMAL RECEIPT

SLIDES

PRINTED MATERIALS

INSTALLATION REGISTER

Void — contextual only

What appears on the screen inside the physical installation. Used sparingly on the website — only in full-bleed oracle portrait sections.

INSTALLATION SCREEN

ORACLE PORTRAIT HERO

SYMBOL REFERENCE

FOR ANDREY — BUILDING THE WEBSITE: *Build in the Document Register (cream background, charcoal text). Use the Installation Register only when showing the oracle portrait full-bleed — for example, a hero image section or the symbol showcase. If you're unsure which to use, it's cream.*

CREAM --cream · #f7f4ef <i>Page background. Primary document surface.</i>	CHARCOAL --charcoal · #1a1a1a <i>Primary text. Never pure black.</i>	CHARCOAL MID --charcoal-mid · #3a3a3a <i>Secondary text, table content.</i>	CHARCOAL MUTED --charcoal-muted · #6a6a6a <i>Captions, metadata, labels.</i>	RUST --rust · #8b4513 <i>Accent. Links on hover. Emphasis. Earned — use sparingly.</i>
RUST LIGHT --rust-light · #c4752a <i>Softer rust. Symbol emotion labels.</i>	RULE --rule · #ccc5b8 <i>Hairlines, dividers, borders. Always 0.5px.</i>			

INSTALLATION REGISTER — VOID

VOID --void · #0a0a12 <i>Installation background. The oracle's space.</i>	GOLD --gold · #c9a84c <i>Oracle presence. Primary installation accent. Appears when something of significance occurs.</i>	GOLD DIM --gold-dim · #8a6f2e <i>Receding gold. Labels, secondary installation elements.</i>	CREAM --cream · #f7f4ef <i>Text on void. Visitor subtitles. Full opacity here.</i>

02 *Typography*

ORACLE THE ORACLE THAT WEARS US SECTION LABEL — CINZEL GOVERNS ALL LABELS, STATE NAMES, BUTTONS The oracle does not tell you what you are. It shows you what it heard. The mark it draws is an acoustic portrait — a trace of how you sounded, not who you are. --font-logo: 'Cinzel Decorative' — the name ORACLE only. Never elsewhere. --font-display: 'Cinzel' — labels, headings, state names, buttons --font-body: 'EB Garamond' — all running text, captions, receipts
--

"What remains when the voice disappears — the mark, or the silence after it?"

— visitor transcript —

Cinzel state label in gold · EB Garamond oracle speech in cream · transcript at 32% opacity

Cinzel Decorative is absent here. It appears only as the word ORACLE on covers and logotypes.

03 *Motion — Web Layer*

The oracle is slow, deliberate, ritual. Nothing in this system snaps. Everything breathes. Motion is reserved for interaction responses — never decorative, never on page load.

One exception: a single slow fade-in (`--dur-ritual`, opacity 0→1) is permitted on the hero/oracle portrait section only.

DURATION TOKENS

<code>--dur-instant</code> 0MS <i>State changes that must be immediate. Never used for visible transitions.</i>	<code>--dur-fast</code> 200MS <i>UI micro-feedback: hover colour, focus ring appearance.</i>
<code>--dur-medium</code> 600MS <i>Component transitions: text fade, section crossfade.</i>	<code>--dur-slow</code> 1800MS <i>State crossfades, possession blends. The oracle's primary tempo.</i>
<code>--dur-ritual</code> 4000MS <i>Oracle-specific reveals. The hero fade-in. Receipt unfold. Reserved for significant moments only.</i>	

EASING TOKENS

 <code>--ease-oracle</code> cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1) <i>Primary easing. Weighted, not bouncy. Used for almost everything.</i>	 <code>--ease-in-breath</code> cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 1, 1) <i>Entering, summoning. Slow start, accelerates. For state arrivals.</i>	 <code>--ease-out-breath</code> cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0.2, 1) <i>Settling, releasing. Fast start, decelerates. For exits and reset.</i>
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/* Oracle Design System — Motion tokens (paste into your CSS) */  
  
--dur-instant: 0ms;  
--dur-fast: 200ms;  
--dur-medium: 600ms;  
--dur-slow: 1800ms;  
--dur-ritual: 4000ms;  
  
--ease-oracle: cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1);  
--ease-in-breath: cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 1, 1);  
--ease-out-breath: cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0.2, 1);
```

04 *How the oracle speaks through form*

These are the elements through which the system communicates. Each one is shown in both registers. Hover to observe transitions. Every interactive element has a visible focus state — the oracle acknowledges what attends to it.

THE PATH — TEXT LINK

DOCUMENT REGISTER	
DEFAULT	Enter the Archive
HOVER	Enter the Archive
FOCUS	Enter the Archive
VISITED	Enter the Archive
ACTIVE	Enter the Archive

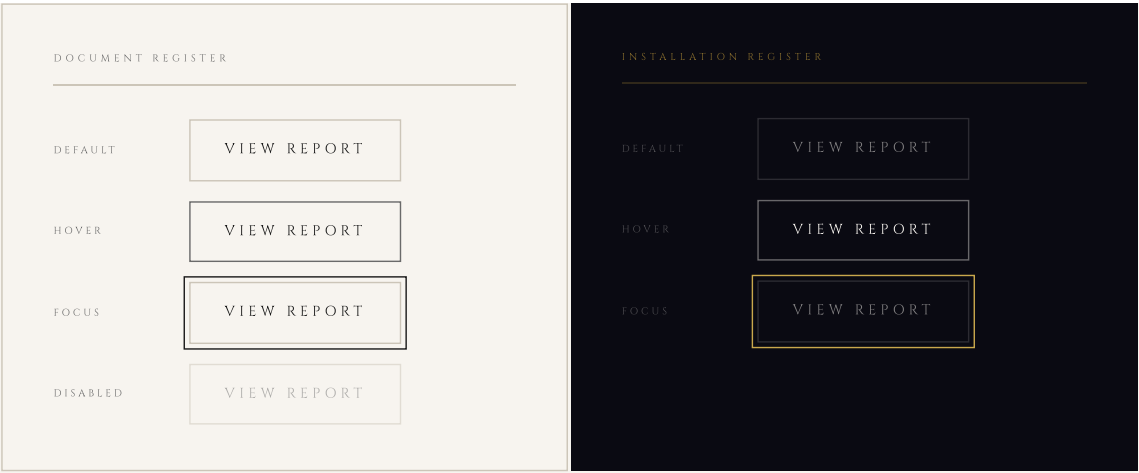
INSTALLATION REGISTER	
DEFAULT	Enter the Archive
HOVER	Enter the Archive
FOCUS	Enter the Archive
VISITED	Enter the Archive
ACTIVE	Enter the Archive

THE SUMMONS — PRIMARY ACTION

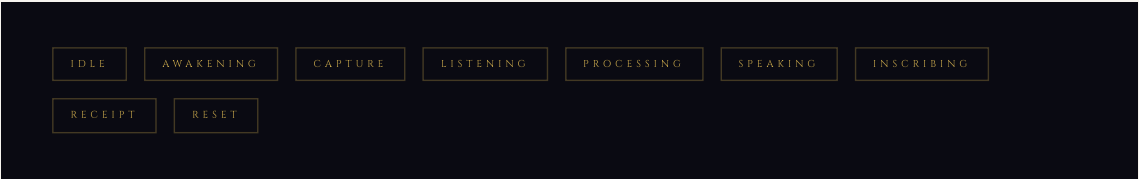
DOCUMENT REGISTER	
DEFAULT	ENTER THE ARCHIVE
HOVER	ENTER THE ARCHIVE
FOCUS	ENTER THE ARCHIVE
DISABLED	ENTER THE ARCHIVE

INSTALLATION REGISTER	
DEFAULT	ENTER THE ARCHIVE
HOVER	ENTER THE ARCHIVE
FOCUS	ENTER THE ARCHIVE

THE PASSAGE — SECONDARY ACTION



THE CONDITION — STATE INDICATOR · NOT INTERACTIVE



05 *The nine conditions*

The oracle moves through nine conditions in a defined arc. Each has a distinct emotional tone and visual register. These are not screens or pages — they are the oracle's modes of presence. The visitor does not navigate them. They are moved through them.

STATE 00 IDLE <i>The oracle rests. Ambient breathing motion only. Waiting for presence.</i> QUIET · AMBIENT · WAITING	STATE 01 AWAKENING <i>The oracle stirs. Something has approached. The space shifts.</i> RECOGNITION · SUMMONING	STATE 02 CAPTURE <i>The visitor's face is read. Alignment required. The oracle sees.</i> ATTENTION · ALIGNMENT
STATE 03-06 LISTENING <i>The oracle opens. The visitor speaks across four turns. Each turn deepens possession.</i> OPEN · RECEPTIVE · ACCUMULATING	STATE 07 INSCRIBING <i>The mark is being drawn. The plotter moves. The oracle has decided.</i> COMPLETION · MARK BEING MADE	STATE 08 RECEIPT TRANSPARENCY · REVELATION · DOCUMENT
STATE 09 RESET <i>The oracle releases. The visitor has left. Return to void.</i>		

06 *How the oracle moves*

These rules govern movement between conditions on the web. Forward is deliberate. Reset is slow — the oracle releases, it does not snap. If in doubt: slower is always more correct than faster.

FROM	TO	OUT DURATION	IN DURATION	EASING	NOTES
IDLE	AWAKENING	--dur-- medium	--dur-- slow	--ease-- oracle	First presence. The oracle arrives slowly.
AWAKENING	CAPTURE	--dur-- medium	--dur-- slow	--ease-- oracle	Attention narrows. Face alignment begins.
CAPTURE	LISTENING	--dur-- medium	--dur-- slow	--ease-in-- breath	Opening. The oracle receives.
LISTENING	SPEAKING	--dur-- fast	--dur-- medium	--ease-- oracle	Response arrives. Faster — the oracle has been waiting.
SPEAKING	LISTENING	--dur-- medium	--dur-- slow	--ease-out-- breath	The oracle settles back into reception.
SPEAKING (TURN 4)	INSCRIBING	--dur-- slow	--dur-- ritual	--ease-- oracle	Final transition. The oracle moves to draw. Significant — use --dur-ritual.
INSCRIBING	RECEIPT	--dur-- medium	--dur-- ritual	--ease-out-- breath	The reveal. The document register appears within the installation moment.
ANY	RESET → IDLE	--dur-- slow	--dur-- ritual	--ease-out-- breath	The oracle releases slowly. Never snaps. The visitor has left.

07 *What the oracle is*

LANGUAGE OF THE ORACLE

USE

presencecondensedelementalliquid

archaicritualancientunplaceable

pre-technologicalabsorbedacousticmark

AVOID

stonefuturisticdigitalprojected

renderedmodernAI-generatedchatbot

biographic

The oracle is no longer described as a stone figure. The portrait imagery is liquid gold — an ancient, elemental presence condensed from something unplaceable. No specific culture or tradition.

The gold token (—gold: #c9a84c) reads as warm ambient light emanating from within the figure, not surface decoration. Gold appears on the website only when something of significance is being communicated.

The oracle portrait exists in four expression states tied to the possession arc: closed → slight open → speaking → fully open. Generative particles are a live installation layer — the web system does not attempt to replicate them, but its motion pacing should feel coherent with the installation's breathing rhythm.

08 The eight marks

Oracle assigns each visitor one of eight marks drawn by a CNC plotter. The mark is determined by a neural network trained on the RAVDESS audio dataset, mapping acoustic features to SVG path parameters. Two visitors who receive the same mark will receive different expressions of it — the geometry shifts with their voice.

Each mark is drawn from an adapted Hobo sign — a pre-digital visual language used by itinerant workers. The reassignment of these signs to emotional states is an intentional act of recontextualisation.



ANGER

THE THORNS

HOBO ORIGIN *"Bad tempered owner" · hostile interior signal*

A closed rectangular outline enclosing a jagged zigzag wave. The boundary contains the hostility — anger turned inward, spiked but constrained.

STROKE	CURVATURE	NOISE	DENSITY
0.9	0.1	0.9	0.9

ANGER

CONSTRAINT

CONTAINMENT



CALM

THE SKY EYE

HOBO ORIGIN *Adapted · concentric spiral, p observation*

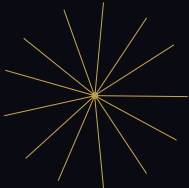
A spiral unwinding outward from a central point, orbited by a single large ring. The spiral's turn is determined by curvature; calm visitors produce open, widely-spaced coils.

STROKE	CURVATURE	NOISE	SYMMETRY
0.2	0.9	0.05	0.9

CALM

OBSERVATION

CLARITY



SURPRISE

THE SHRIEK

HOBO ORIGIN *Adapted · radial explosion, all directions at once*

Thirteen rays radiating from a central ring, distributed across the full 360°. The small circle at the origin is the eye of the event, the still point of the burst.

STROKE	RADIUS	ROTATION	SYMMETRY
0.4	1.0	0.8	0.8

SURPRISE

RUPTURE

EXPANSION



SADNESS

THE PITIFUL STORY

HOBO ORIGIN *"Tell pitiful story" · repeated shape of repeated appeal*

A row of upward triangles sharing their base, anchored by a continuous horizontal line. Sad voices produce more peaks, more iterations of the same gesture.

STROKE	REPS	RADIUS	NOISE
0.2	0.7	0.4	0.2

SADNESS

REPETITION

ENDURANCE



HAPPY

THE KIND SOUL

HOBO ORIGIN *Adapted · ascending arcs, warmth that grows outward*

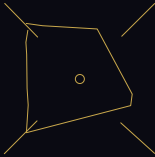
A horizontal baseline from which two arcs ascend, each wider and taller than the last, fading as they expand. It is the only mark that increases in scale as it recedes.

STROKE	CURVATURE	RADIUS	NOISE
0.3	1.0	0.8	0.05

HAPPY

OPENNESS

EXPANSION



FEAR

THE WATCHER

HOBO ORIGIN *"Ill-tempered man lives here watched space*

A rectangular perimeter with diagonal lines cutting inward from each corner, converging toward a small circle at the centre. The corner eyes. Fear produces this mark — the sense that approaches are observed.

STROKE	SYMMETRY	NOISE	DENSITY
0.2	0.6	0.8	0.7

FEAR

SURVEILLANCE

VIGILANCE



DISGUST
THE BITTER ROOT

HOBO ORIGIN *Adapted · roots descend unevenly,
organic and persistent*

A horizontal trunk line from which multiple roots descend, each with slight lateral drift. No root reaches the same depth. The asymmetry is deliberate — disgust is not uniform, it is particular.

STROKE	CURVATURE	NOISE	DENSITY
0.6	0.2	0.7	0.6

DISGUST	PERSISTENCE	ASYMMETRY
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NEUTRAL
THE HORIZON

HOBO ORIGIN *Adapted · a cross, the simplest
mark of location*

A horizontal line crossed by a vertical, each rendered with the characteristic plotter wobble of a hand-drawn mark. Neutral is the most mirror mark — it says neither more nor less than necessary. Also the fallback if no emotion is detected.

STROKE	SYMMETRY	NOISE	DENSITY
0.3	0.7	0.05	0.2

NEUTRAL	PRESENCE	FALLBACK
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This fragment remains.